

RELOCATION GUIDE

Melbourne

Naarm

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Melbourne.

Room to grow a career. A city to fall for.

Melbourne is the choice for clinicians who want the whole system: more tertiary, quaternary and specialist services than anywhere else in Australia, with a world-class medical research precinct beside them. Around that sits a city that is wonderful at being a city, with trams to almost everywhere, laneway cafés, a year-round festival calendar and wine country an hour away.

~5.3M

people in Greater Melbourne

250 km

of tram track, the world's largest network

~40%

of residents born overseas

1 hr

to the Yarra Valley, the Peninsula or Geelong

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Melbourne

Clinicians choose Melbourne for the depth of the system, and stay for a city that rewards curiosity in every direction: clinical, cultural and culinary.



If you're looking for a beach at the end of the street and sunshine every day, Melbourne may not be it. If you're drawn to a big, rich system, a city full of culture and a career with room to grow, it could be a great choice.

Greater Melbourne is home to around five and a quarter million people, neck and neck with Sydney as Australia's largest city. The centre is the Hoddle Grid, laid out in 1837: walkable, wrapped in gardens and threaded with laneways. Around it run rings of Victorian terraces, leafy family suburbs and bayside villages, with Port Phillip Bay to the south and the Dandenong Ranges rising to the east.

For clinicians, the draw is **depth**. Melbourne carries more tertiary and quaternary services than any other Australian city, standalone specialist services in fields such as paediatrics, women's health, cancer, eye and ear and mental health, and an internationally significant biomedical research precinct clustered around the inner-city campuses. If your sub-specialty is narrow, or you want research and teaching braided into clinical work, this is the strongest market in the country.

A typical week might look like this: a tram to work from an inner-north terrace, a registrar teaching session in the afternoon and a research meeting you can actually join. Coffee that is quietly excellent from a café with eight seats. Friday dinner down a laneway, Saturday at the market and the football, and Sunday under the tree ferns in the Dandenongs or among the vines in the Yarra Valley.

WHAT YOU GAIN

A career with range

The next sub-specialty, fellowship or research post is usually a tram ride away, not an interstate move.

A city that works without a car

Live near a tram line and the inner city is small, easy and lively.

A world of food and culture

Galleries, theatre, live music, sport and some of the best food and coffee anywhere.

Communities already here

About four in ten residents were born overseas, so very few newcomers arrive somewhere without their people.

GOOD TO KNOW

Four seasons, often in a day

Winters are cool and grey, summers bring some hot days. A good coat and a warm home make all the difference.

Second on the cost tables

Clearly below Sydney, above Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth. Choosing where you live well is what makes it comfortable.

A big footprint

Pick your home by the tram or train line to your campus and the commute stays easy.

A bay, not a surf coast

Port Phillip is calm and lovely for a swim; the surf is an hour away on the Peninsula or the Surf Coast.

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An honest word before you decide

Melbourne is one of the most sought-after destinations in Australia, and competition for healthcare roles here is very high. Securing a role, and particularly a sponsored role, is considerably more challenging in Melbourne than in regional Australia. We are not saying it's impossible, but we want to be honest with you: it can take longer, and it helps to be flexible. Many clinicians start in a regional city, where demand and sponsorship are often stronger, and move to Melbourne later with Australian experience behind them.

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Weighing up your options?

People often compare Melbourne with Sydney for scale, Brisbane for winter sunshine and a gentler housing market, and Adelaide for a major-hospital career at a lower cost of living. Regional Victoria (Geelong, Ballarat, Bendigo) offers substantial services with more space. Melbourne usually offers the most career doors; we are happy to talk any of them through.



Birrarung Marr, a five-minute walk from the city centre



Hosier Lane: the city's laneways are best explored on foot



Iron-lace terraces and autumn leaves in Melbourne's inner suburbs.



Melbourne's city centre on a clear autumn day.

Melbourne at a glance

Melbourne is unusually easy to read for a city of its size: a grid at the centre, rings of suburbs around it, and a tram network that makes the whole inner city navigable within a week of arriving.

The **centre** is the Hoddle Grid: numbered blocks, main streets with laneways behind them, and the Yarra, or Birrarung, along its southern edge. Southbank and Docklands extend it across and down the river, and gardens ring it on three sides. Most of the tertiary hospital work sits inside this ring or just north and east of it.

The **inner rings** each have their own personality. North: Carlton, Fitzroy, Brunswick and Northcote, with terraces, students, live music and wonderful food. East: Richmond, Hawthorn and Kew, leafier and quieter. South: South Melbourne, Albert Park and St Kilda, with the bay at the bottom of the street. West: Footscray, Yarraville and Williamstown, the fastest-changing part of the city.

Beyond about fifteen kilometres, the **outer city** opens into growth corridors north, west and south-east, with newer homes, bigger gardens and their own hospitals. The bay curls south to the Mornington Peninsula, the Dandenong Ranges rise to the east, and Geelong sits an hour south-west as a city in its own right.



The Yarra at Southbank, a short walk from the city centre

Summer

DEC – FEB

Warm and bright, typically around 14–26°C, with some hot days each year. Long evenings, rooftop bars, the bay and the tennis in January.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 11–20°C, settled and golden. Many locals' favourite season, and the food and wine festival is on.

Winter

JUN – AUG

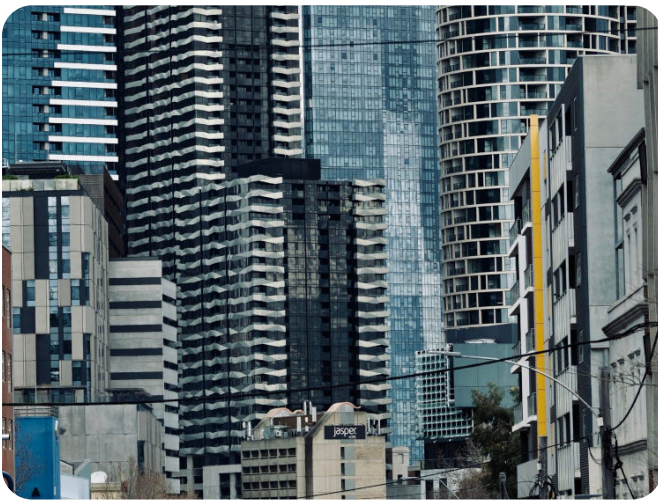
Cool and crisp rather than freezing, around 7–14°C, with grey days and cosy evenings. Football season, wine bars and galleries.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 10–20°C and wonderfully changeable, with blossom, the racing carnival and the city coming outdoors again.

"Four seasons in one day" is the local saying, and it comes from geography: cold fronts arrive off the Southern Ocean and can cross the city in an hour. Locals simply dress in layers and carry a jacket. Spring and autumn are the best of it, and summer delivers long, light evenings until well after eight.



A grey winter's day in the city: the season for layers, good coffee and long lunches



The city centre from the north, where many of the inner-city campuses sit

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A note on Country

Melbourne stands on the lands of the Wurundjeri Woi Wurrung and Boon Wurrung peoples of the Kulin Nation. Naarm is the name you will see used widely alongside Melbourne, including by health services. Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings, and Victoria's treaty and truth-telling processes are among the most advanced in the country, so cultural induction is current, meaningful context.

WEEK ONE

Myki

The tap-on card for trams, trains and buses across the city.

DRIVING

Hook turn

Turning right from the left lane in the city, to keep the trams moving. Alarming once, then normal.

SPORT

The G

The MCG, the cricket ground that becomes the football's home in winter.

PUB MENUS

Parma

Chicken parmigiana, the pub classic. Here it is always a parma.



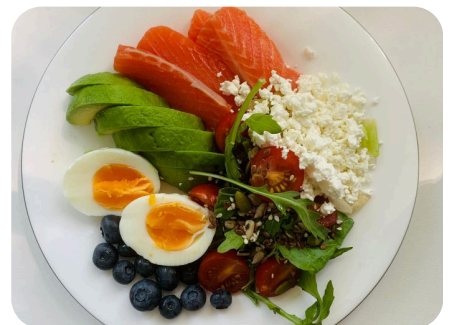
Geelong on Corio Bay, Victoria's second city, an hour south-west of Melbourne



The skyline from Kings Domain, part of the green ring around the city



A sacred kingfisher: native birds are part of everyday life in Victoria's parks



Breakfast out is a weekend institution

Healthcare and work in Melbourne

Registration is national; hiring here is service by service. Melbourne's great strength is depth: the widest range of tertiary, quaternary and specialist services in the country, with an internationally significant research precinct beside them.

Victoria runs its public system through a number of separately governed health services, each employing in its own right. In Melbourne that means several major metropolitan services, each with a tertiary campus and a group of community and specialist sites around it, plus standalone specialist services. There is also a substantial private hospital sector and a large private imaging and pathology market, which is good news for radiographers, sonographers and allied health professionals looking for variety.

In practice, "a job in Melbourne" is a job in one service, on one campus, in a city fifty kilometres across, and a later move between services is a fresh application. That makes the order of decisions simple: choose the service and campus first, then the suburb.

NATIONAL REFERRALS

Quaternary depth

The widest range of highly specialised services in Australia, including work referred from other states.

OWN CAREER LADDERS

Standalone specialist services

Paediatrics, women's health, cancer, eye and ear, and mental health each run as services in their own right, creating career paths that smaller systems cannot offer.

CLINICIAN-RESEARCHERS

A research precinct

Medical research institutes clustered around the inner-city campuses, with joint university appointments and real research pathways.

AHPRA

One national register

Registration works everywhere in Australia, so the paperwork you start now travels with you.



A big system means big variety: acute, specialist, community and research roles across the city

Deepest

tertiary and research
system in Australia

5

specialist fields run as
standalone services

paediatrics, women's
health, cancer, eye and
ear, mental health

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national registration

through Ahpra, valid in
every state

For a career, this means choice. Higher training posts, fellowships and joint appointments are more plentiful here simply because there are more services creating them. It suits you best if you want range and specialisation; if you would rather have broad scope and fast responsibility, a smaller system might suit you better, and we will happily talk that through.

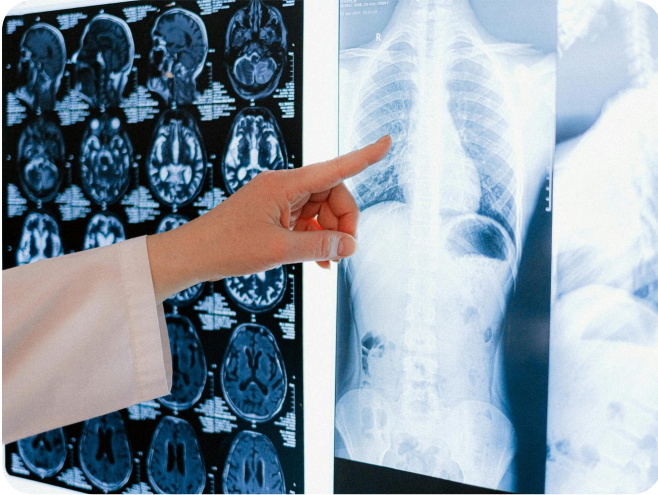
The new Metro Tunnel, which opened in late 2025, added a station at Parkville, in the heart of the university and medical precinct, making the inner-city campuses easier to reach by train from both the south-east and the north-west. Pay follows Victorian awards and enterprise agreements; we quote no figures here and will walk you through the current agreement for your profession instead.

Giving yourself the best chance in Melbourne

- ✓ Be open to more than one campus, service or shift pattern. The wider your search, the better your chances.
- ✓ Get your registration well under way early. Employers here often favour candidates who can start sooner.
- ✓ Keep a regional option alongside Melbourne. Regional cities often have stronger demand and are more able to sponsor, and Australian experience makes a later move to Melbourne much easier.
- ✓ Talk to us early, so we can give you a realistic picture for your profession and specialty.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which service and which campus? The same title can mean quite different work across this city.
- ☐ How does salary packaging work, and can I start it from day one?
- ☐ What is the roster pattern: shifts, on-call frequency and how gaps are covered?
- ☐ Is research or teaching time protected, and how do joint appointments work?
- ☐ What CPD time and funding is there, and is conference travel supported?
- ☐ What supervision and support is there in the first year for clinicians trained overseas?
- ☐ What are staff parking and public transport like at my actual shift times?



Imaging and allied health are in strong demand across public and private services



International clinicians are a familiar and valued part of Melbourne's workforce



Care that people remember.



A warm welcome on the ward.

Where to live in Melbourne

In Melbourne the tram line shapes the life. Live within an easy walk of one that runs to your campus and the city becomes small and easy. Here is the map as we would draw it over coffee.

~10–20 MIN · FOOD, MUSIC, TRAMS

The inner north

Carlton, Fitzroy, Collingwood, Brunswick and Northcote: bluestone lanes, Victorian terraces, live music and some of the best food in the country. A natural first landing for clinicians without children; Coburg and Preston offer the same feel a few stops further out.

~15–25 MIN · LEAFY, FAMILY

The inner east

Richmond, Hawthorn, Camberwell and Kew: big trees, well-regarded schools and an easy run to the eastern campuses. Box Hill and Doncaster beyond offer more space, a long-established Chinese-Australian community and wonderful food.

~15–25 MIN · BEACHES

The south and the bay

South Melbourne, Albert Park and Port Melbourne put the bay at the end of the street. St Kilda and Elwood are lively; Brighton and Hampton further south are family territory with the famous bathing boxes.

~10–25 MIN · VALUE, VILLAGES

The west

Footscray, Seddon, Yarraville and Williamstown: the best value inside ten kilometres, Vietnamese and East African food, village pockets and Williamstown's waterfront looking back at the skyline. Mostly served by train rather than tram.

~45–75 MIN · SPACE, NEW HOMES

The growth corridors

Craigieburn in the north, Werribee and Melton in the west, Dandenong and Pakenham in the south-east: new homes, big blocks, young families and their own hospitals. Ideal if you work locally.

IF YOU WANT...	CONSIDER	BECAUSE
Food, music and no car	Carlton, Fitzroy, Brunswick	Trams everywhere, walk to everything
Family space and schools	Hawthorn, Camberwell, Kew	Leafy and established, near the eastern campuses

IF YOU WANT...	CONSIDER	BECAUSE
The bay at the end of the street	Albert Park, Elwood, Brighton	Trams and water, family-friendly
Great value close in	Footscray, Yarraville, Williamstown	On the train line and changing fast
Inner-north life for less	Coburg, Preston, Northcote	The same feel, a few stops further out
A new house and a garden	The growth corridors	Space and value, best paired with a local campus



Victorian terraces with iron lace balconies, a signature of Melbourne's inner suburbs



A summer evening swim at Brighton, with the city skyline across the bay

Most clinicians we move here rent first, often for six to twelve months, and then decide where to settle once they know the rings and their roster. Renting works the same way across Australia: a bond of about four weeks' rent, lodged with the state's bond authority, and a good application ready before you inspect.

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ Which tram or train line is it on, and does it reach your campus without a change?
- ☐ What heating does it have, and is there insulation? Older terraces and weatherboards can be chilly in July, so a well-heated home is worth prioritising.
- ☐ Is it in the government school zone you want? Zones are checked by address.
- ☐ What is the commute like at 6.30am and 10pm, not just at 9am?
- ☐ Would a short-term rental first be wiser while you get to know the city?



Eastern Beach in Geelong: some clinicians choose Geelong for space, the bay and an hour's train ride to the city



Johnstone Park in central Geelong



Heritage architecture in Geelong's city centre



The bay trail along Corio Bay, Geelong



Summer evenings on the Geelong waterfront

Getting around Melbourne

Melbourne is the Australian city where living without a car is genuinely easy, if you live in the right ring. The tram network is the largest in the world, the trains radiate out to the suburbs, and the whole thing runs on one card.

ONE CARD

Myki

Tap on across trams, trains and buses, with a daily fare cap. The Free Tram Zone covers the city centre: no tap, no charge.

250 KM · 24 ROUTES

Trams

Frequent and everywhere in the inner city, and the reason inner Melbourne works so well without a car.

METRO AND V/LINE

Trains

Radial lines to the suburbs and on to Geelong, Ballarat and Bendigo. The Metro Tunnel added five new stations under the city in 2025.

FLAT AND GRIDDED

Bikes

Separated lanes along the Yarra and through the inner north make this one of Australia's better cities for a bike commute.

FROM THE CITY CENTRE TO...	ROUGHLY	HOW
The inner north (Fitzroy, Brunswick)	10–20 min	Tram
The inner east (Richmond, Hawthorn)	15–25 min	Tram or train
The bay (Albert Park, St Kilda)	15–25 min	Tram
The west (Footscray, Williamstown)	10–25 min	Train
Melbourne Airport	~30 min	SkyBus or road
The growth corridors	45–75 min	Train or freeway
Geelong	~1 hr	V/Line train or drive
Sydney	~90 min	Fly, one of the world's busiest air routes

Car-free life is realistic almost anywhere within about ten kilometres of the centre, especially north, east and south. In the growth corridors, most households run a car and use the train line for the city. Australians drive on the left, and the main cross-city freeways are tolled, so it is worth setting up a toll account early. Overseas licence holders can drive on their licence for a period after arriving, and convert to a Victorian licence through VicRoads if they stay longer than six months.

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The hook turn

In the city centre you turn right from the left-hand lane, waiting at the front of the intersection until the lights change, so the tram tracks stay clear. It feels unusual exactly once. The other rule to know: never pass a stopped tram on the kerb side while its doors are open.



Geelong's waterfront, about an hour from the city by V/Line train

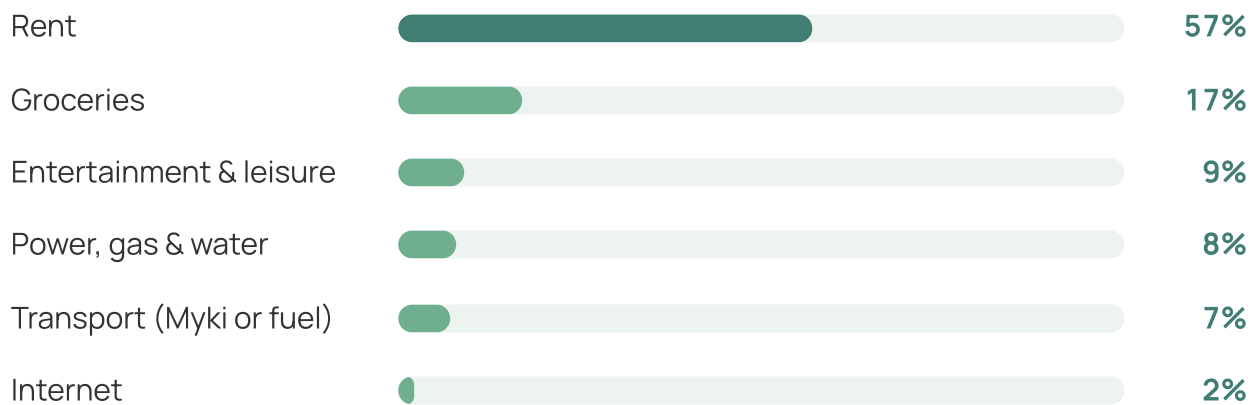
What it costs to live here

Melbourne sits second on Australia's cost tables: clearly below Sydney and above Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth. On a clinical salary it is very liveable, and a few smart choices make it comfortable.

The structural point is simple: an inner-ring flat on a tram line is very achievable on a clinical salary, while an inner-ring family house is a bigger commitment. Which one you need shapes the whole budget, and many families find a happy middle in the middle-ring suburbs or near a campus in the growth corridors.

We do not print prices, because they change every quarter. What changes slowly is the shape of a month, and that is what is shown below. For today's figures, the comparison sites in the local directory let you put Melbourne side by side with the city you are leaving.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest line, lower than Sydney and higher than the other capitals.

Worth planning for

- ✓ Winter heating. Many homes use gas heating and older terraces can be draughty, so a well-insulated, well-heated home is worth a little more rent.
- ✓ Enjoying the city. Restaurants, festivals, football and theatre are part of why people come, so leave room in the budget to use them.
- ✓ Car or no car. Inside the tram rings you may need none; in the outer corridors most households run one or two, plus tolls on the cross-city routes.
- ✓ The move itself. Temporary accommodation, a bond of about four weeks' rent plus rent in advance, and some winter bedding.



The cheese hall at Queen Victoria Market: the markets often beat the supermarkets on value and quality

Plenty comes back, too. Public transport can remove a whole car from the budget. Many of the best things are free: the gardens, galleries with free entry, the laneways, the bay beaches and a festival calendar that runs most of the year. Fresh food from the markets is excellent value, and Victoria grows much of what it eats within a couple of hours of the city. Public-health and not-for-profit roles can also salary-package part of your pay before tax; ask payroll on day one.

IN SHORT

- ✓ On a clinical salary you will live well, especially in a flat or home near a tram or train line.
- ✓ Choose a warm, well-insulated home and budget a little for winter heating.
- ✓ Decide early whether you need an inner-ring house or flat: that one choice shapes the budget most.



Australian dollars: proportions move slowly, prices move every quarter, so check today's figures before you plan



Fresh, colourful food everywhere



Breakfast at the campsite: many of the best weekends cost very little



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Melbourne

Melbourne is where I send people whose careers need room: the sub-specialists, the ones who want research alongside clinical work, the ones who will thrive in a big system. It delivers that better than anywhere in Australia, and the next step in your career is usually across town rather than across the country.

What I also tell people is to choose with care. Pick your campus first, then a home near a tram or train line to it, and make sure it is warm in winter. Do that, buy a good coat, and you will find the most complete city in the country, with wonderful food, culture and communities from every corner of the world waiting for you.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Flavours of home are easy to find across Melbourne



A weekend among the vines: wine country is an hour from the city

Food, coffee and everyday life

Melbourne's food culture is the product of a century of migration, Italian, Greek, Vietnamese, Lebanese, Ethiopian, Chinese and Indian, layered onto a city dense enough to support small, specific places. The coffee is the way in.

The coffee standard here is high and refreshingly unpretentious: espresso brought by Italian and Greek migrants in the 1950s, refined by a generation of local roasters, and now simply normal. Order a flat white, a long black or a "magic" (a short double ristretto with steamed milk, a local invention) and expect it to be good almost anywhere with a queue. Within a fortnight you will have a favourite café within a few hundred metres of home.



Fresh produce at Queen Victoria Market, a Melbourne institution since 1878

WEEKLY RITUAL

The markets

Queen Victoria Market in the city, Prahran and South Melbourne for keen cooks, Footscray and Dandenong for great value and a world of ingredients.

EXPLORE ON FOOT

The laneways

Small bars and restaurants up staircases and down alleys. Ask a colleague; the best ones are passed on by word of mouth.

EAT THE WORLD

Neighbourhood food streets

Lygon Street for Italian, Sydney Road for Lebanese and Turkish, Victoria Street for Vietnamese, Box Hill for Chinese, Foster Street in Dandenong for Indian.

PUB CLASSIC

The parma

Chicken parmigiana with chips and salad, a fixture of every pub menu. It is always a parma here.

This is the easiest Australian city in which to find whatever you grew up eating. Halal butchers across the north and west, kosher grocers and bakeries around Caulfield, Balaclava and Elsternwick, South Asian shops in the eastern and south-eastern suburbs including Dandenong's Little India, African grocers in Footscray, and Asian supermarkets almost everywhere. The shops usually come with something more valuable: the associations, places of worship and weekend gatherings that make a city feel like home within months.



The gateway to Chinatown on Little Bourke Street, one of the oldest Chinatowns in the western world



Kirtan at a Melbourne gurdwara: established communities of every faith are part of the city

The rhythm of the year

- ✓ Summer: the Australian Open in January, cricket at the MCG, rooftop bars and the bay.
- ✓ Winter: the football from March to September, galleries, wine bars and long lunches.
- ✓ Autumn: the food and wine festival, the comedy festival, the Grand Prix and the city's best weather.
- ✓ Spring: the racing carnival, blossom and the city coming outdoors again.



The flat white: your local café will matter more than your supermarket



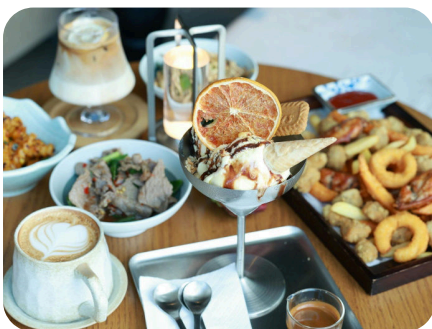
Weekend markets in Melbourne range from fresh food to vintage clothing and design



Vietnamese, Thai, Malaysian and Chinese food are everyday Melbourne staples



Japanese food, from lunchtime sushi to fine dining



Weekend brunch, a Melbourne institution



The classic Australian café breakfast



Shared tables, with friends old and new

What people do at the weekend

Melbourne's weekends work outward in rings: the bay for a morning, the ranges or the valley for a Sunday, and the Great Ocean Road for the weekend everyone does at least twice a year.

Port Phillip Bay is calm, shallow water rather than surf: lovely for a morning swim, a paddle or a pier walk, from Williamstown round to Brighton's bathing boxes. East of the city, the Dandenong Ranges rise into mountain ash and tree ferns, with a historic steam railway and plenty of tea rooms. North-east, the Yarra Valley is wine country, famous for cool-climate pinot noir and chardonnay and long lunches with a view.

And then there is the city's own calendar: a Saturday at the football with ninety thousand others, a free gallery on a rainy afternoon, an evening at the Botanic Gardens or a picnic by the Yarra. There is always something on, and most of it is walkable from a tram stop.

~15–25 MIN

The bay beaches

St Kilda, Elwood, Brighton and Williamstown: piers, paddleboards, bathing boxes and fish and chips at sunset.

~1 HR

The Dandenong Ranges

Sherbrooke Forest, the Thousand Steps, Puffing Billy and Devonshire tea under the tree ferns.

~1 HR

The Yarra Valley

Cellar doors, a sparkling wine tradition, cheese, chocolate and hot-air balloons over the vines at dawn.

~1–1 HR 30

The Mornington Peninsula

Hot springs, calm bay beaches on one side and Southern Ocean surf on the other at Portsea and Sorrento.

~1 HR

Lerderberg Gorge

Bushwalking, river crossings and picnics in a rugged state park north-west of the city.



Brighton's bathing boxes, about twenty-five minutes from the city



The Yarra Valley, an hour north-east: Victoria's best-known wine country



Walking in the Lerderderg State Park, about an hour north-west

Ten weekends to start with

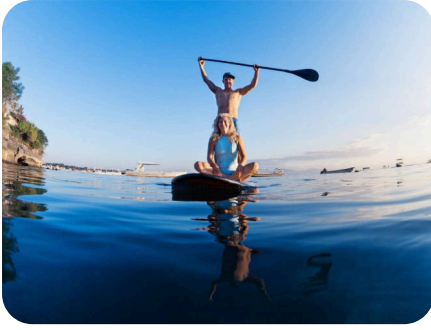
- ✓ The Great Ocean Road to Apollo Bay, staying overnight rather than rushing.
- ✓ A Yarra Valley cellar-door lunch and the drive back over the ranges.
- ✓ The Mornington Peninsula: hot springs, then the surf beach at Sorrento.
- ✓ Phillip Island and its famous little penguin parade.
- ✓ The High Country in winter for snow, or in summer for the rivers.
- ✓ The Twelve Apostles at dusk, when the tour buses have gone.
- ✓ The Dandenongs: Sherbrooke Forest, the steam railway and tree ferns.
- ✓ Wilsons Promontory for a proper walk and white-sand beaches.
- ✓ A day on the bay: Williamstown, the ferry and Brighton's bathing boxes.
- ✓ A Saturday at the football, whichever team a colleague talks you into.



The Great Ocean Road: the weekend drive everyone does at least twice



Surf beaches are an hour or so away on the Peninsula and the Surf Coast



Calm water for paddleboarding



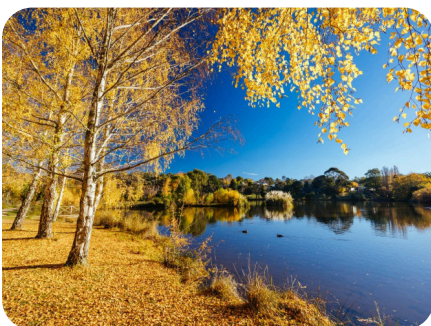
Waking up somewhere new on a long weekend



Victoria has more than twenty wine regions to explore



The Yarra Valley, about an hour east of the city



Daylesford in autumn, about 90 minutes north-west



A town in Victoria's High Country



Canola in flower in country Victoria

Easy trips from Melbourne

Victoria is a compact state with a great deal packed in: one of the world's great coastal drives, spa country, gold-rush towns, wine regions, wildlife and ski fields, much of it within a day's drive.

The **Great Ocean Road** starts about ninety minutes from the city and runs for over two hundred kilometres along the Southern Ocean: the surf at Torquay and Bells Beach, rainforest and waterfalls behind Lorne and Apollo Bay, koalas in the trees at Kennett River, and finally the limestone stacks of the Twelve Apostles. It is a weekend rather than a holiday from Melbourne, and most people do it more than once.

Inland, **Daylesford** and Hepburn Springs are spa country, with mineral springs, lakes and Sunday markets, while the gold-rush cities of **Ballarat** and **Bendigo** offer grand Victorian streetscapes and family-friendly attractions. In winter, the **Victorian Alps** are a real draw: Mt Buller is about three hours away, with Falls Creek and Mt Hotham further on, and Lake Mountain and Mt Baw Baw closer still for a first day in the snow.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
St Kilda & the bay beaches	~20 min by tram	The nearest beaches: calm bay water, a palm-lined foreshore, the pier and sunset fish and chips.
Melbourne Airport	~30 min	Direct flights across Asia, the Middle East and the Pacific, and constant shuttles to Sydney.
Geelong	~1 hr	The nearest other city: a relaxed waterfront, the Surf Coast on its doorstep and the overnight ferry to Tasmania.
Yarra Valley & Dandenong Ranges	~1 hr	Wine country, tree-fern forest and a historic steam railway.
Torquay & the Great Ocean Road	~1 hr 30	Surf beaches, coastal walks and one of the world's great drives.
Phillip Island	~2 hrs	The little penguin parade at dusk, surf beaches and wildlife.
Mt Buller (Victorian Alps)	~3 hrs	The nearest major ski resort, with a season of roughly June to September, snow permitting. Lake Mountain is closer for tobogganing and cross-country.
Falls Creek & Mt Hotham	~4 hrs 30	Bigger alpine resorts for a ski week or a summer in the High Country.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Sydney	~90 min flight	Australia's other great city, for a long weekend.



Geelong's painted bollards on the waterfront, about an hour south-west of Melbourne

~3 HRS

The Twelve Apostles

Limestone stacks rising from the Southern Ocean. Go at sunset and stay the night in Port Campbell or Apollo Bay.

~1 HR 30

Daylesford & Hepburn Springs

Spa country: mineral baths, lakeside walks, galleries and Sunday markets.

~3 HRS

Wilsons Promontory

The southernmost tip of mainland Australia: granite headlands, white beaches and wombats on the walking tracks.

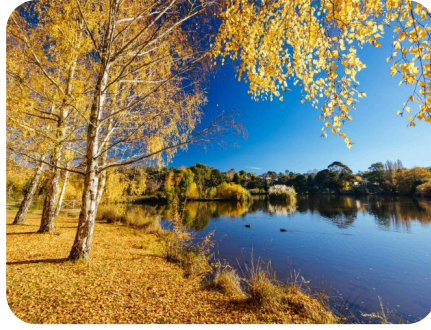
~3-4 HRS

The High Country

Snow in winter; rivers, rail trails and historic towns such as Bright and Yackandandah in summer.



The Twelve Apostles at sunset, at the far end of the Great Ocean Road



Autumn at Lake Daylesford, in Victoria's spa country



Yackandandah, a historic town on the way to the High Country



Koalas: one of the wildlife encounters that delight new arrivals



Kangaroos grazing at dusk are a common sight on the edge of the city and in the state parks

Families and schools

Melbourne is a wonderful city to grow up in: parks and playgrounds everywhere, sport for every age, free museums and galleries, and a school system with plenty of choice.



After the bell: the school day ends mid-afternoon, leaving time for sport and the beach



Victoria funds kindergarten for three- and four-year-olds at participating services

Victorian children start school in **Prep**, the year they turn five or six by the end of April, and go on to primary school (Prep to Year 6) and secondary school (Years 7 to 12), finishing with the Victorian Certificate of Education (VCE) or the VCE Vocational Major. The school year runs from late January to December in four terms.

Around six in ten students attend **government schools**, which are free for local families and allocate places by address through school zones. Alongside them are **Catholic** schools, with modest fees, and **independent** schools, many with long histories and a wide range of fees. Victoria also has a small number of highly regarded selective-entry government high schools, entered by exam from Year 9.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the school zone at the exact address before you sign a lease, using the Victorian Government's Find My School tool.
- ☐ Visit, or ask for a video call. Principals are used to international families and are happy to talk.
- ☐ Ask about English as an Additional Language support and how new arrivals are welcomed.
- ☐ Budget for uniforms, which are bought from the school's uniform shop or its appointed supplier.



School fees on a temporary visa

Victoria generally does not charge tuition fees at government schools for the children of skilled temporary visa holders, such as the subclass 482 and 494, though some other temporary visas do pay. Check your exact visa with the Victorian Department of Education's International Education Division before you enrol.

What children tend to love here



Melbourne Zoo, and the wildlife sanctuary at Healesville in the Yarra Valley.



Puffing Billy, the steam train through the Dandenongs.



Auskick, the junior Australian rules football programme, plus netball, cricket, soccer, swimming and Little Athletics.



Scienceworks, the Melbourne Museum and its children's gallery, and free entry to the National Gallery of Victoria.



The bay beaches in summer, and the penguins of Phillip Island at dusk.



A first day in the snow at Lake Mountain or Mt Buller.



Early childhood

Victoria's Free Kinder programme funds kindergarten for three- and four-year-olds at participating services, and long day care is widely available, with the Australian Government's Child Care Subsidy helping eligible families with the cost.

EIGHT ACROSS THE CITY

Universities

Including the University of Melbourne, Monash, RMIT, Deakin, La Trobe, Swinburne, Victoria University and Australian Catholic University, with strong health and medical faculties.

VOCATIONAL STUDY

TAFE

Large TAFE institutes such as Holmesglen, Box Hill Institute and Melbourne Polytechnic, with health, community services and trade courses.



Holiday programmes and water sports keep weekends and school holidays busy



Learning to surf is a rite of passage for many Victorian children



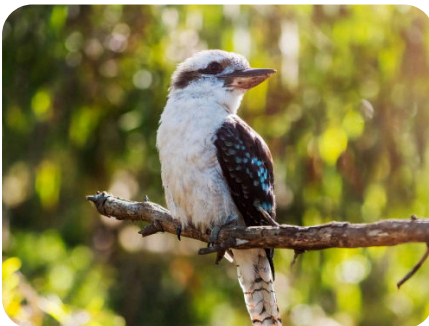
Creative play is at the heart of early learning



Outdoor play is part of every day in early childhood education



Senior students work towards the VCE or the VCE Vocational Major



Kookaburras: you will hear them before you see them



After the rain on Geelong's waterfront, a favourite day out with children



Surf lessons on the coast welcome every age

“

Melbourne suits clinicians building a career with range, and gives them a city they never run out of.

Your Melbourne address book

About four in ten Melburnians were born overseas, so almost every community has an association, a place of worship and a grocer somewhere in the city. Indian, Sri Lankan, Filipino, African, British and Irish communities are all long established, and the multicultural councils and migrant resource centres below are a good first call if you are not sure where to start.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

City of Melbourne

The central city council: libraries, parks, events and services for the CBD and inner suburbs

melbourne.vic.gov.au

Victorian Government

State services, including finding your local council by address

vic.gov.au

Public Transport Victoria

Journey planner, timetables and Myki for trams, trains and buses

ptv.vic.gov.au

NURSE-ON-CALL

Free 24-hour health advice line from a registered nurse, anywhere in Victoria

1300 60 60 24

VicEmergency

Fire danger ratings, total fire bans and emergency warnings; worth downloading the app

emergency.vic.gov.au

GETTING TO KNOW THE PLACE

Visit Melbourne

The official visitor site: events, food, neighbourhoods and day trips

visitmelbourne.com

Live in Melbourne

Victorian Government guide for new arrivals, including profiles of the city's communities

liveinmelbourne.vic.gov.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Live in Melbourne: multicultural communities

Victorian Government guide to more than twenty-five of the city's communities, including Indian, Sri Lankan, Filipino, South African, Zimbabwean, British and Irish, and where each tends to live

liveinmelbourne.vic.gov.au

Ethnic Communities' Council of Victoria

The statewide peak body for migrant and refugee communities, based in Coburg

03 9354 9555 eccv.org.au

Filipino Community Council of Victoria

Peak body for Filipino-Australian associations across Victoria, with events and community programmes

filipinocommunitycouncilofvic.org.au

Nigerian Society of Victoria

Membership association for Nigerians in Victoria: Nigeria Day, festivals and social events

nigeriansocietyvic.org.au

Melbourne Malayalee Federation

Malayalee cultural group: music, dance, Onam and other festivals (listed on the government's LiveUp directory; runs through its Facebook page)

AMES Australia

Settlement support and English classes for new arrivals, including the free Adult Migrant English Program for eligible visa holders

13 26 37 ames.net.au

Spectrum Migrant Resource Centre

Settlement, family, youth and employment support for migrants in Melbourne's north and west

03 9977 9000 spectrumvic.org.au

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Alphonsa Syro-Malabar Cathedral, Epping

Cathedral of the Syro-Malabar Eparchy of Melbourne, with Mass in Malayalam and English; the eparchy site lists parishes across the city

syromalabar.org.au

Syro-Malankara Catholic community, Elsternwick

Holy Qurbono on the second and fourth Sundays at St Joseph's, Orong Road, Elsternwick

malankaracatholicchurch.in

Catholic Archdiocese of Melbourne

Find a Catholic parish and Mass times anywhere in Melbourne

melbournecatholic.org

St Mary's Indian Orthodox Cathedral, Coburg

Malankara Orthodox cathedral for Melbourne's Indian Orthodox community

stmarysioc.org.au

Planetshakers

Large Pentecostal church founded in Melbourne, with campuses across the city

planetshakers.com

Islamic Council of Victoria

Peak Muslim body; its AskICV finder lists mosques, prayer spaces and services, and it runs the City Mosque in West Melbourne

icv.org.au

Shri Shiva Vishnu Temple, Carrum Downs

One of Melbourne's largest Hindu temples, run by the Hindu Society of Victoria

hsvshivavishnutemple.org.au

Sri Guru Nanak Satsang Sabha, Blackburn

Gurdwara in the eastern suburbs, 127 Whitehorse Road
03 9894 1800

Gurdwara Sri Guru Granth Sahib, Keysborough

Gurdwara in the south-east, 198–206 Perry Road
03 9798 1313

Buddhist Council of Victoria

Directory of member temples and centres across Victoria

bcv.org.au

Jewish Community Council of Victoria

Peak body for Victoria's Jewish community, with links to synagogues and community organisations

jccv.org.au

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Little India Cultural Precinct, Dandenong

Two blocks of Foster Street beside Dandenong station: Indian and subcontinental grocers, spices, restaurants and wedding wear

greaterdandenong.vic.gov.au

Kosher Kingdom, Elsternwick

Kosher grocer at 482B Glen Huntly Road: groceries, wine, cheese and fresh food

03 9523 6019

Kosher Australia

Kosher certification body based in Caulfield, with a searchable list of certified products and outlets

kosher.org.au

Islamic Council of Victoria: AskICV

Service finder that includes halal food and community services across Victoria

icv.org.au

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

National supermarket chain, with stores in almost every suburb

woolworths.com.au

Coles

National supermarket chain, with stores in almost every suburb

coles.com.au

ALDI

Discount supermarket with a smaller, good-value range
aldi.com.au

Queen Victoria Market

The city's great market since 1878: produce, meat, deli and specialty shopping; open Tuesday, Thursday to Sunday
qvm.com.au

Prahran Market

Historic fresh-food market in South Yarra, a favourite of keen cooks
prahranmarket.com.au

South Melbourne Market

Village market since 1867: produce, dim sims and a lively weekend atmosphere
southmelbournemarket.com.au

Dandenong Market

Traditional working market since 1866, with a huge range of international produce and great value
dandenongmarket.com.au

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

Find My School

Victorian Government tool to find your zoned government school by address
findmyschool.vic.gov.au

Victorian Department of Education

School enrolment, Free Kinder and, through its International Education Division, fee rules for students on temporary visas
education.vic.gov.au

School uniforms

Bought from each school's uniform shop or its appointed supplier; the school will tell you which

PSW

School uniform supplier with stores across Victoria and online click-and-collect for many schools
psw.com.au

State Schools' Relief

Charity that helps families in need with uniforms and essentials, arranged through the school
stateschoolsrelief.org.au

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

The largest rental and sales listings site
realestate.com.au

Domain

Rental and sales listings, with suburb profiles
domain.com.au

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and house shares, handy for your first few months
flatmates.com.au

Residential Tenancies Bond Authority

Where your rental bond is lodged and held; check and claim it online
rentalbonds.vic.gov.au

Consumer Affairs Victoria

Renting rules, minimum standards and your rights as a tenant
consumer.vic.gov.au

Tenants Victoria

Not-for-profit advice and information for renters
tenantsvic.org.au

GETTING AROUND

Public Transport Victoria

Journey planner, timetables, Myki and fares across Melbourne and regional Victoria
ptv.vic.gov.au

VicRoads

Driver licences, registration and converting an overseas licence (required if you stay more than six months)
vicroads.vic.gov.au

Linkt

Toll account for CityLink and other Melbourne toll roads

linkt.com.au

SkyBus

Express bus between Melbourne Airport and the city

skybus.com.au

COST COMPARISON LINKS**Numbeo: Melbourne**

Crowd-sourced cost-of-living figures; compare Melbourne with the city you are leaving

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Melbourne

Victorian Energy Compare

Official Victorian Government site for comparing electricity and gas offers

compare.energy.vic.gov.au

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official price and consumer price index data

abs.gov.au

**Checked October 2026**

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 ahpra.gov.au

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

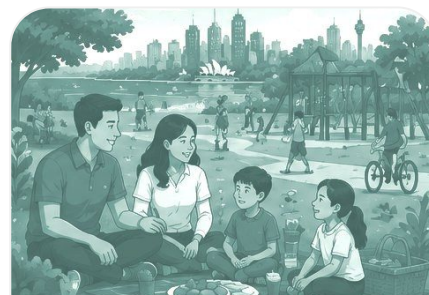
We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Melbourne. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

hello@ethicareresourcing.com · +44 7375 019544 · ethicareresourcing.com

One Coldbath Square, London EC1R 5HL · Company No. 14646354